

Plastic Army Men Recon Pack



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Plastic Army Men Recon Pack

Version: 1.0

Author: Chris Burns

Overview

Plastic Army Men Recon Pack is a free sample of my larger collection of models, weapons, characters and vehicles in a plastic toy style. Inspired by the 90s PC game by 3DO and the toys I grew up with. If you would like to upgrade to the full Plastic Army Men Pack and receive future updates at no extra cost, you can do so here:

<https://assetstore.unity.com/packages/3d/characters/plastic-army-men-319733>

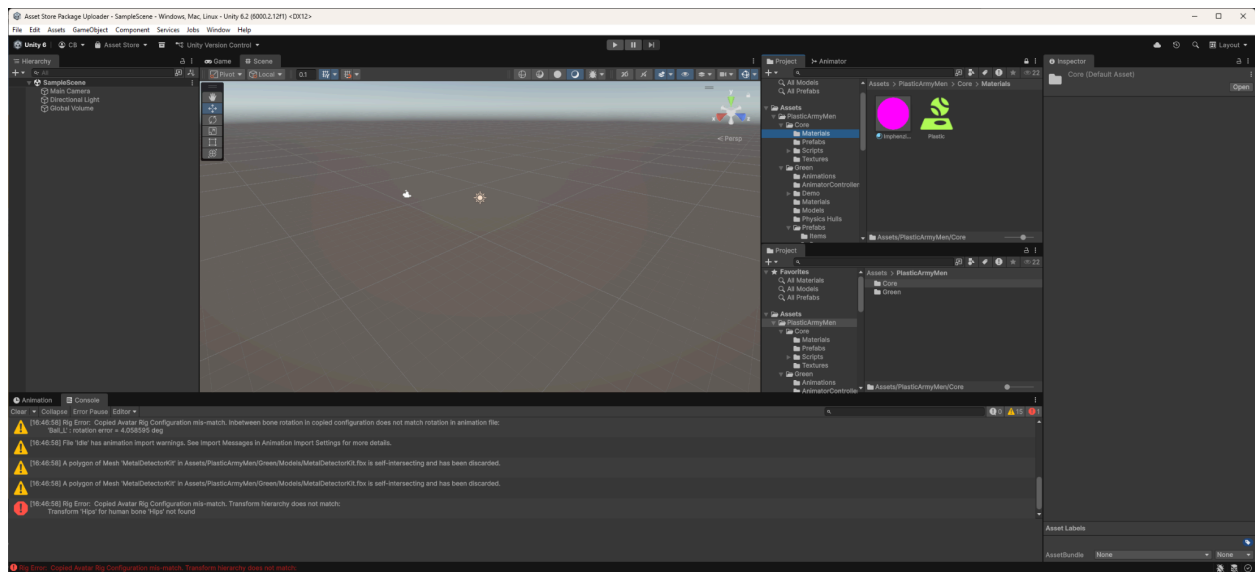
Installing

After downloading and importing the project, if there are Rig Errors in the console, these can be ignored. The texturing in this asset pack uses the [Imphenzia Pixpal shader](#), which is [available for free](#) and allows for easy texture sharing and packing for the objects in the pack.

If you notice the prefabs and models look magenta, simply navigate to:

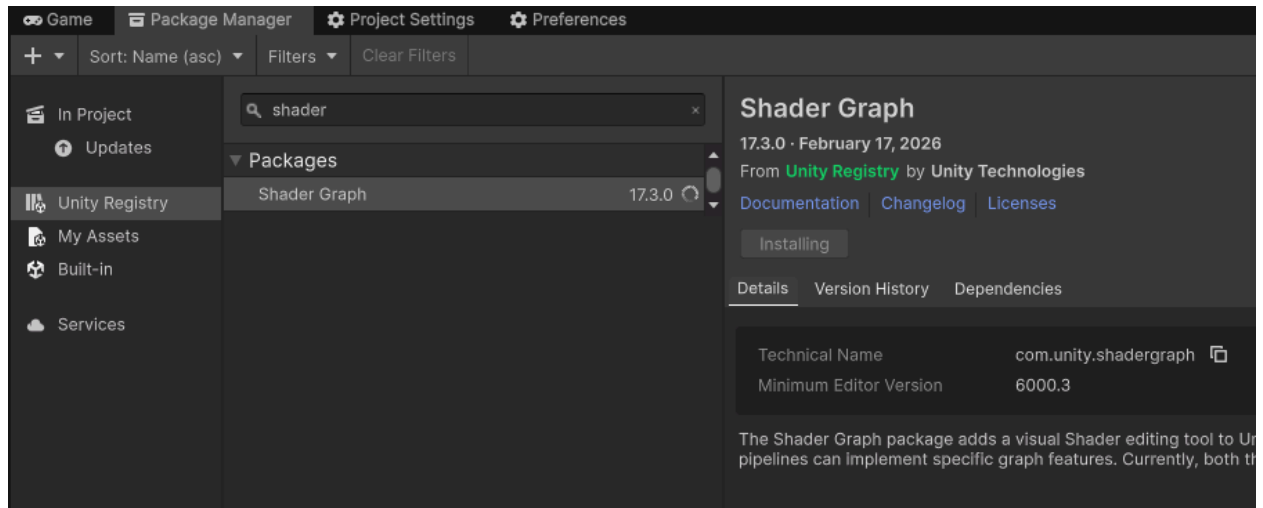
PlasticArmyMen/Core/Materials, select the ImphenziaPixPal_URP material and set its shader type to **Shader Graphs/ImphenziaPixPal_URP**.

Saving your project should regenerate the previews of the assets, fixing any magenta previews

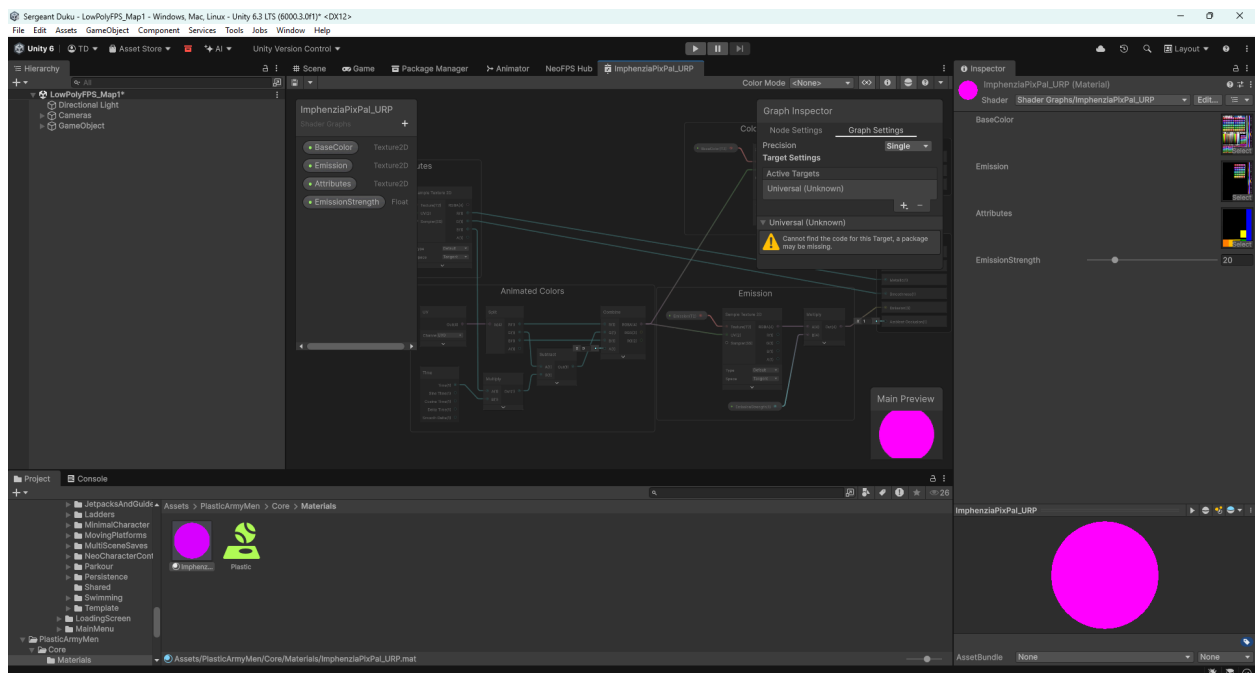


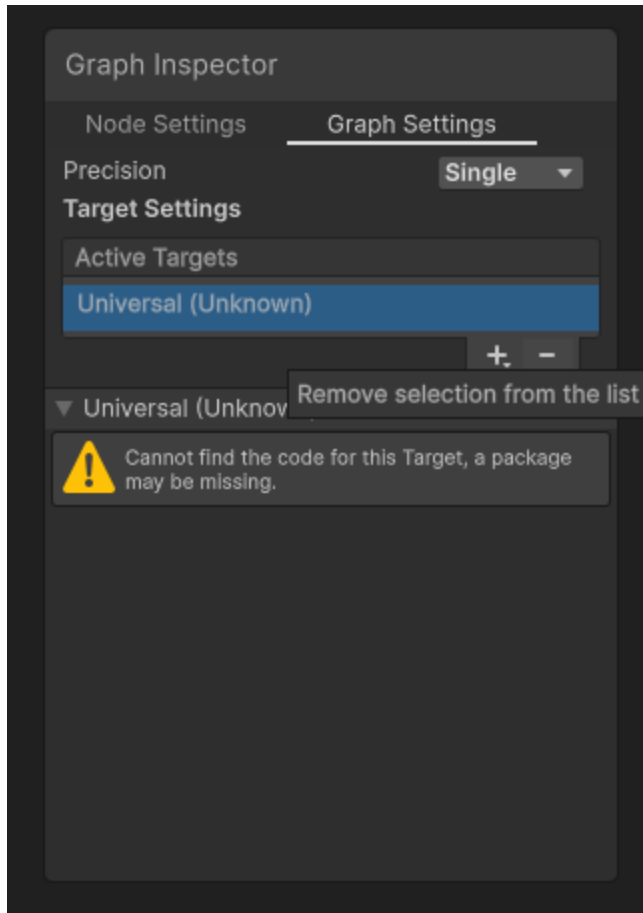
Built-in Render Pipeline Setup

To set up the project to work with the Built-in Render pipeline, you will need to update the materials in the project. Firstly, download the ShaderGraph package if it is not already in your project from the Package Manager window.



Once installed, find the Imphenzia PixPal_URP Material and set its Shader type to: **Shader Graphs/ImphenziaPixPal_URP** Then press the **Edit...** button next to the dropdown to open the ShaderGraph window. In this window, you will see a yellow warning icon that indicates an unknown Active Target (Universal) in the Graph Inspector.





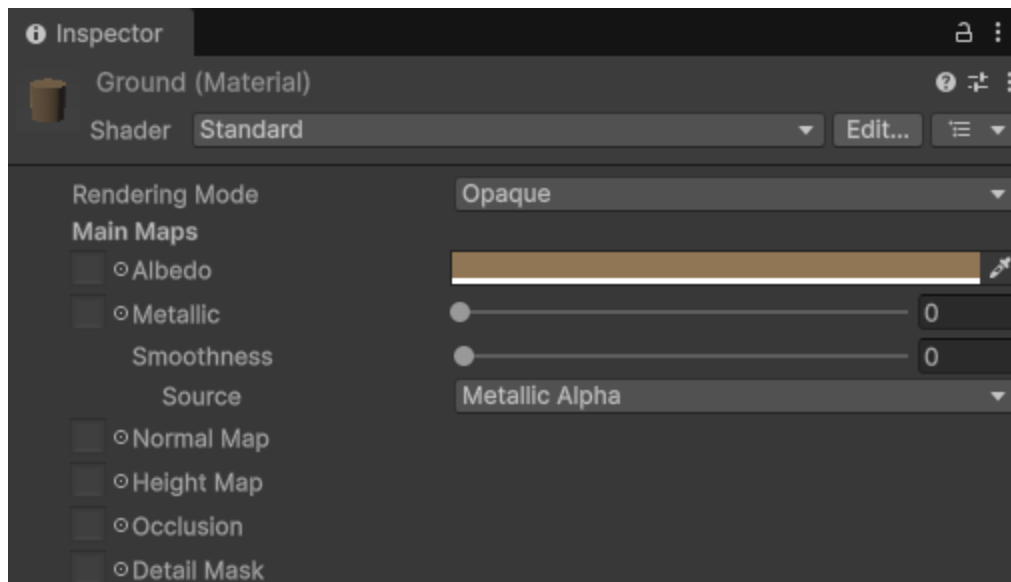
Simply remove this, and add the Built-In type to the list, then save the Shader with the disc icon in the top left corner of the ShaderGraph window.

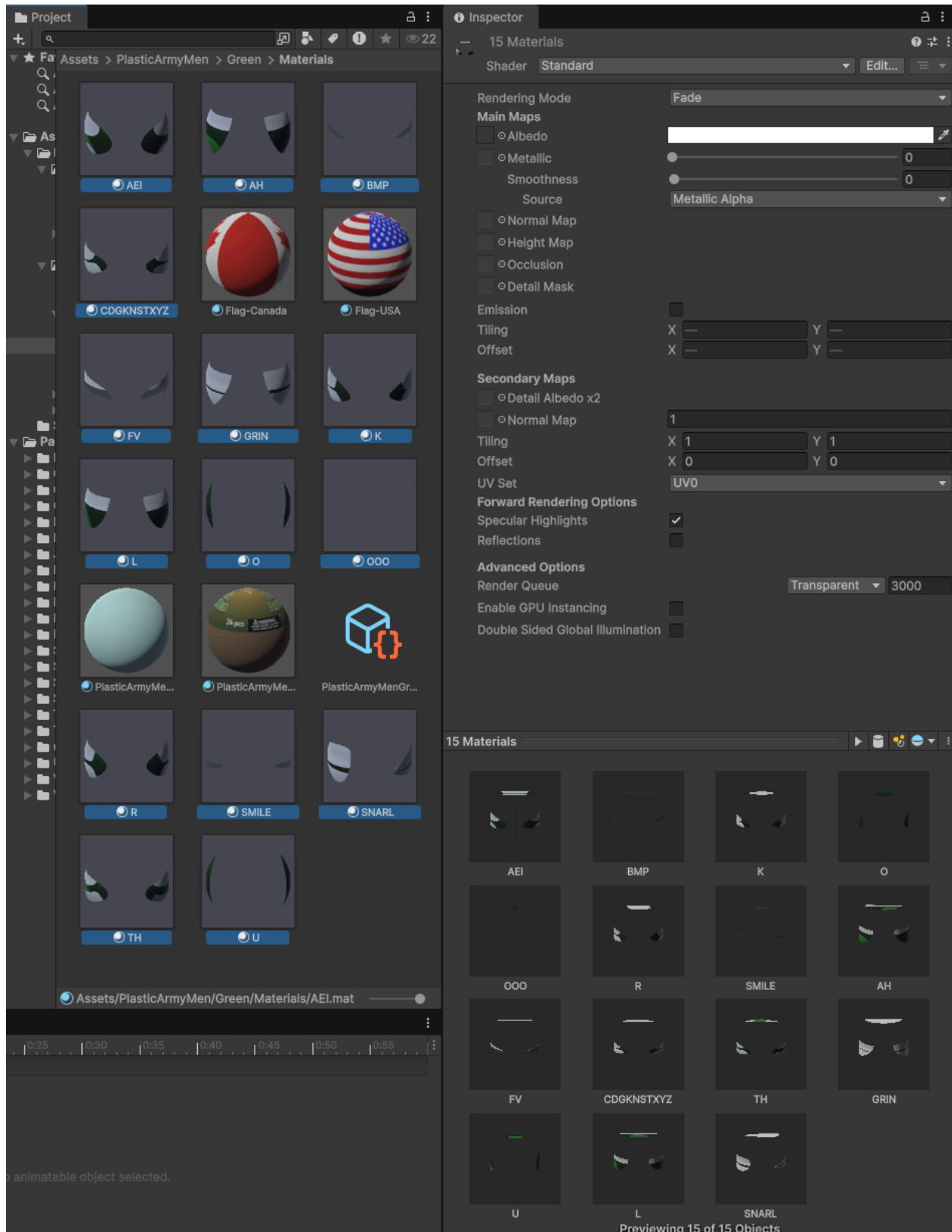
If you then save the Unity project, the magenta preview of the material should also update.

Other materials in the project, such as the Ground, Flags, etc can all be set to **Standard** for their Shader type.

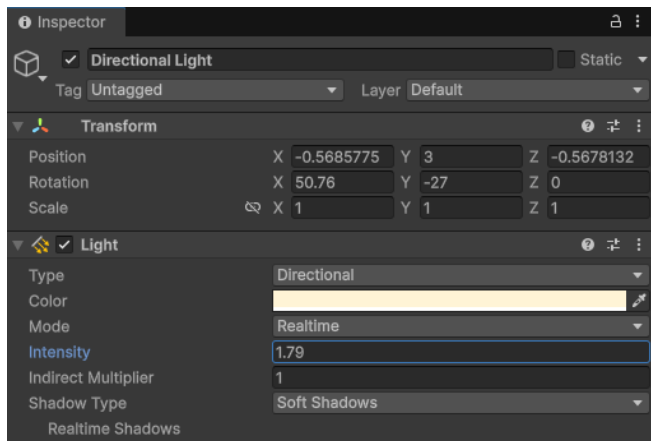
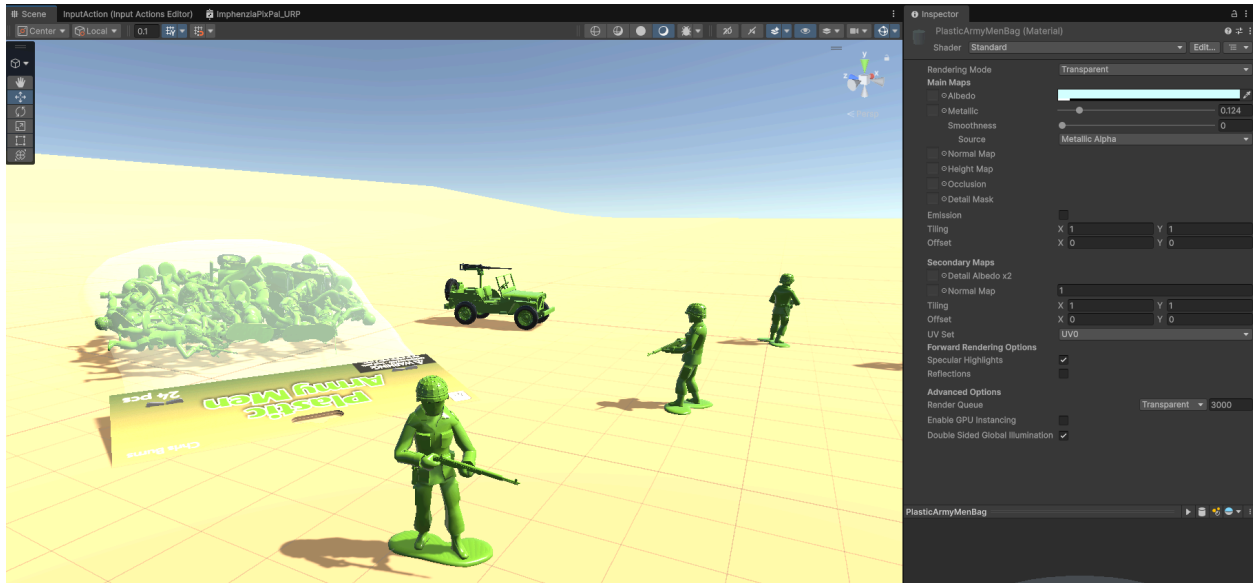
PlasticArmyMenBag(Material) should also have its Rendering Mode set to **Transparent**.

Face materials such as AEI, AH, BMP, etc. should have their Rendering Mode set to **Fade**, and their Source set to **Metallic Alpha**





The Mouth materials should also be set to **Standard**, and their Rendering Mode to **Fade**, their Source to **Metallic Alpha**, which will make them transparent.



The demo scene should now look as above, with all materials set up; the scene itself may look overexposed due to being set up for URP. Simply select the Directional Light and lower its **Intensity** to something closer to **1.79**



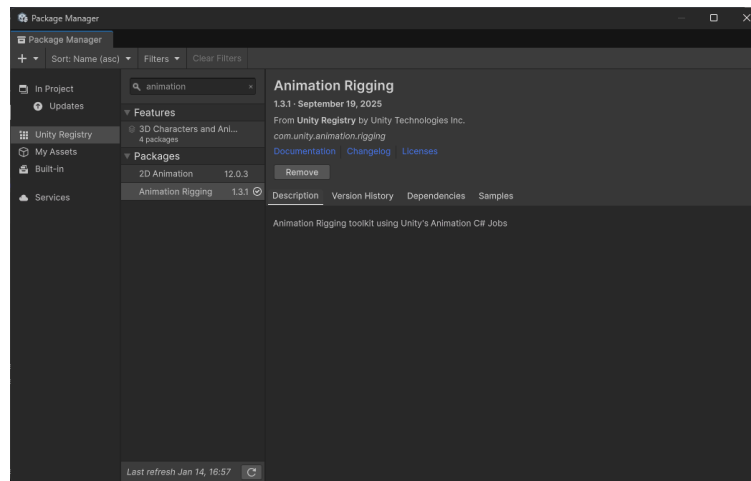
Final Set up in Built-in Render Pipeline

(Note: These screenshots are from the full Plastic Army Men pack.)

Animation & Rigging package

This Asset also uses Unity's Animation & Rigging package for handling the IK chain physics used for the Radio Man, Flamethrower, etc. You can download this from the Package Manager under Unity Registry, and search for Animation:

(The included Rifleman in the Recon Pack does not require the Animation Rigging package)



How to use the included Base Plate Controller?

All prefab characters have an included Base Plate Controller script component on them.

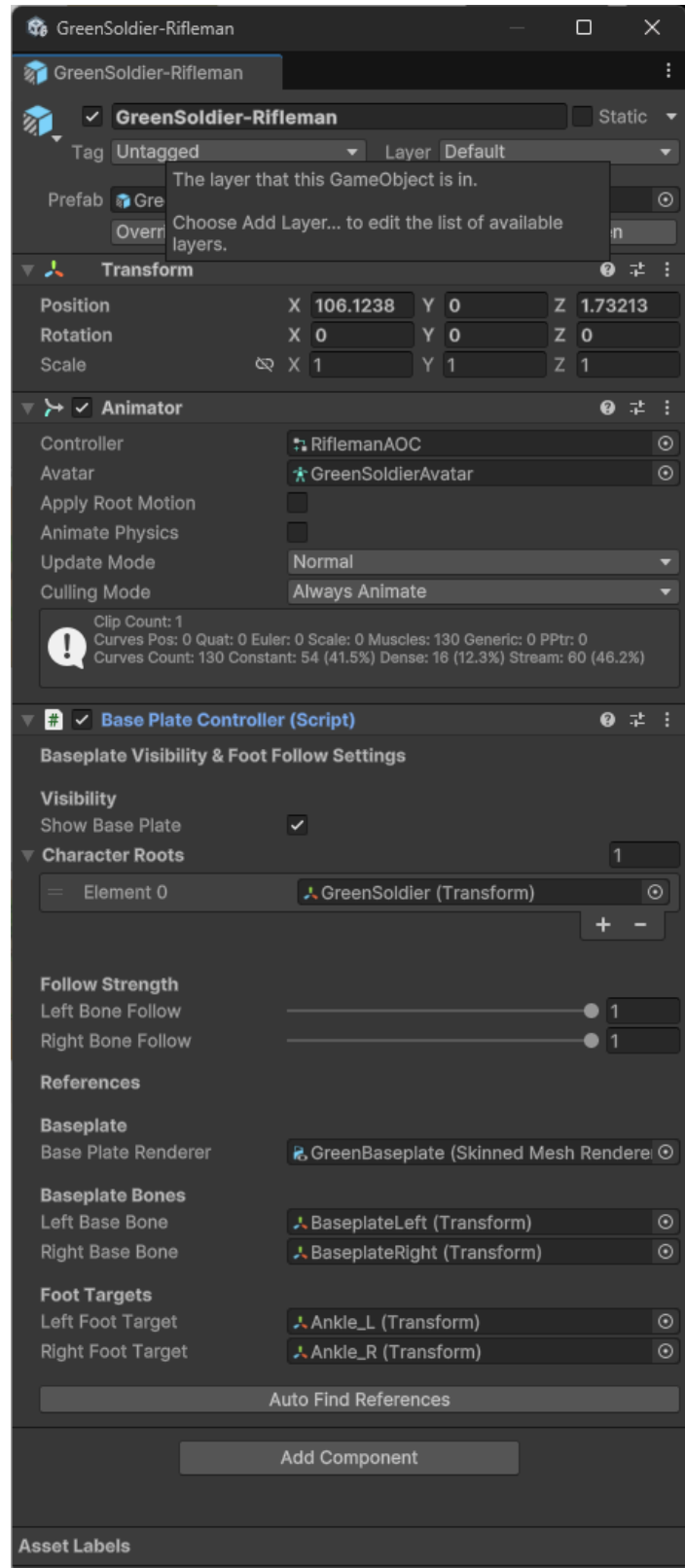
This is used for easily hiding and showing the base plate that gives them the iconic toy look, as well as for controlling its distortion during animation.

When the **Show Base Plate** bool is disabled, the character's mesh is offset down slightly (the thickness of the base plate) so that their feet remain on the ground. This does not affect the actual transform of the character, so it should not affect your character controller scripts. If you do not wish for this to happen, you can simply leave the 'Character Roots' array empty. This is where you assign the root of the rig, and any additional items that would need to be offset, such as backpacks (see Radioman or Flamethrower for example).

Follow Strength controls the weighting between the Baseplate bones and their follow targets (the foot bones).

Baseplate is the Skinned mesh of the baseplate.

Baseplate Bones are the two bones that allow it to bend and twist



Foot Targets are the positional and rotational targets for the Baseplate bones to follow.

Auto Find References will help you reconnect these references if you lose them, just take note that the Character Roots array is populated, as this may not find all the items needed for the positional offset.

Note: If you ever need to correct the vertical position of the character, if they are clipping below the floor or floating above it when they should not be, you can toggle the '**Show Base Plate**' bool, then disable the component, re-toggle the bool and then enable the component.

This tool works in both Editor and Runtime modes, and the options could be animated on or off for individual animations or controlled via the Animator via Events Behaviours for when a character mounts a vehicle or performs a pose that distorts the Baseplate too much.

Support & Feedback

If you encounter any issues or have feature requests, please don't hesitate to reach out. Suggestions for expanding this collection are welcome!

I am working on my own games currently, '[Restoration Simulator](#)' and '[Epic Adventure Quest](#)', you can find out more about them on the Discord channel below:

Email: info@chrisburns.com.au

Discord: <https://discord.gg/DSUd2QcyHZ>

Website: <http://www.chrisburns.com.au>